out a bit more about Victoria: her surname, for a start.

Just a month or so later, we were down in London to play Chelsea and, before the game, someone in the dressing room said that a couple of the Spice Girls were at Stamford Bridge.

Which ones? Is Posh here? Where are they sitting? Somehow or other, I kept the excitement to myself. Maybe this was the chance I'd been waiting for. Later, I found out that it was Victoria, along with Melanie Chisholm, who'd come to the game. As I went up to the players' lounge, I was praying she would be there.

I met up with Mum and Dad. Victoria and Melanie were chatting in one corner. Their manager walked over and introduced himself:

'Hello, David. I'm Simon Fuller. I look after the Spice Girls. I'd like you to meet Victoria.'

I could feel little beads of sweat starting to roll down my forehead. Suddenly it was very hot indeed in that lounge. She came over. I didn't have a speech ready, so all I could manage was:

'Hello, I'm David.'

Victoria seemed pretty relaxed. I think she and Mel had had a glass of wine or two. In the game I'd scored with a volley, which I hoped might have impressed her, until I found out she hadn't been wearing her glasses. The truth was Victoria didn't really have a clue what had been going on during the match. She was looking at me and, I guessed, didn't have the faintest idea who I was. Man United? Chelsea? Were you even playing today? Later, someone reminded her that she'd picked my picture out of an album of soccer stickers when the Girls had been doing a photo shoot in team outfits a few days before. Knowing nothing about the game, she'd been the only one who hadn't made up her mind whose uniform to wear. Looking at those pictures had been part of trying to decide which team she was going to pretend to support. Right then, though, that picture wasn't doing me any good at all.

'I'm Victoria.'

And that was that. I couldn't think what to say next. Simon Fuller rattled on for a bit about the game: I can't say I remember a word of it. She went back into her corner with Melenie. I went back to where my mum and dad were standing. I looked across the room at Victoria. Stared, in fact: I couldn't